

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR SUB-INSPECTOR UNDER FOOD, CIVIL
SUPPLIES & CONSUMER AFFAIRS DEPARTMENT AND RECEPTIONIST
UNDER HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE DEPARTMENT,
GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(MAY-2025)

QUESTION BOOKLET

PAPER-I
(General English)

Question
Booklet Series

A

Time Allowed : 3 hours

Maximum Marks : 100

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Immediately after the commencement of the examination, you should check that this question booklet does not have any unprinted or torn or missing pages or items, etc. If so, get it replaced by a complete question booklet of the same series.
2. Write and encode clearly the question booklet series A, B, C or D as the case may be in the appropriate place in the OMR Answer Sheet.
3. **Particulars/Details to be filled up in the OMR Answer Sheet should be filled up completely and correctly, OMR Answer Sheet of candidates failing to do so will NOT be evaluated.**
4. This Question Booklet contains *Section- 'A' & 'B'*. *Section - 'A' should be answered only on the Answer Sheet and Section - 'B' should be answered only on OMR Response Sheet provided.*
5. After the examination has concluded, you should hand over the OMR and the Answer Sheet to the Invigilator only. You are permitted to take away with you the Question Booklet.
6. Separate sheets for rough work will be provided in the Examination Hall.
7. There are no negative marks for incorrect answer.

SECTION - A (Conventional Type) (40 Marks)

*This Section should be answered only on the **Answer Sheet** provided.*

Marks for each question is indicated against it. Attempt all questions.

1. Read the following passage carefully and write a precis in about one third of its length. Suggest a suitable title. (10)

In the modern world, money is often seen as the ultimate measure of success and security. People devote their lives to earning more, believing that wealth guarantees happiness, comfort, and respect. While money undoubtedly plays a crucial role in meeting basic needs and providing opportunities, it is not the most important thing in life. Beyond a certain point, the pursuit of money can lead to stress, unhealthy competition, and strained relationships.

True happiness and fulfillment often come from sources that money cannot buy—such as love, health, peace of mind, and meaningful human connections. A wealthy person without friends or health is not truly rich. Moreover, ethical values, compassion, and a sense of purpose add far more to a person's life than material possessions. The world has seen countless examples of individuals who, despite limited means, lived content and impactful lives.

Money should be viewed as a tool, not a goal. It is meant to support life, not define it. A balanced approach—where one earns enough for comfort but does not let money dictate all decisions—is essential for a wholesome life. As societies evolve, there is a growing realization that quality of life cannot be measured by income alone, but by the richness of experiences, relationships, and personal growth.

2. Write a letter to the Engineer in Chief, Power and Electricity Department complaining about the frequent breakdown of electricity in your locality. Sign yourself as Engliana. (15)
3. Read the following passage carefully and answer the question that follows.

Exercise is essential for maintaining a healthy lifestyle. It helps improve cardiovascular health, strengthens muscles, and boosts the immune system. Regular physical activity also reduces the risk of chronic diseases such as heart disease, diabetes, and obesity. Additionally, exercise plays a crucial role in mental well-being by reducing stress, anxiety, and depression.

There are different types of exercises, including aerobic exercises like running and swimming, strength training like weightlifting, and flexibility exercises such as yoga and stretching. A combination of these exercises ensures overall fitness and health. Experts recommend at least 30 minutes of moderate exercise per day to maintain good health.

The lack of physical activity has become a major concern, especially with modern lifestyles that involve sitting for long hours. Many people spend excessive time on screens, leading to a sedentary lifestyle. This can result in weight gain, muscle weakness, and poor cardiovascular health. To stay active, individuals can take small steps such as walking instead of driving, using stairs instead of elevators, and participating in sports or outdoor activities.

Governments and health organizations promote exercise through awareness campaigns, fitness programs, and policies that encourage active lifestyles. Schools also play a key role by including physical education in their curriculum. Exercise is not just about fitness—it is a way to enhance the quality of life and increase life expectancy.

Questions:

- (a) _____ exercise includes activities like running and swimming (1)
- (b) A sedentary lifestyle can lead to _____ gain (1)
- (c) Synonym of 'guarantee' (second paragraph) (1)
- (d) Antonym of 'diminish' (fourth paragraph) (1)
- (e) Give one way how school can promote physical activity? (1)

- (f) What are flexibility exercises mentioned in the passage. (2)
- (g) Why is exercise important for overall health? (2)
- (h) How does exercise contribute to mental well-being? (2)
- (i) How can individuals include more physical activity in their daily routine? (2)
- (j) What role do governments and health organizations play in promoting exercise? (2)

SECTION - B (Multiple Choice questions) (60 Marks)

All questions carry equal mark of 1 each. Attempt all questions.

*This Section should be answered only on the **OMR Response Sheet** provided.*

Direction (Question Nos 1-5) : Identify the Parts of Speech of the underline words.

1. Gentle words win hearts of other.
(a) noun (b) pronoun
(c) verb (d) adjective.
2. The earth is round in shape.
(a) adjective (b) verb
(c) noun (d) adverb
3. He looks very happy.
(a) adverb (b) pronoun
(c) adjective (d) noun
4. Beauty needs no ornaments at all.
(a) pronoun (b) adjective
(c) noun (d) verb
5. They arrived soon after.
(a) adjective (b) adverb
(c) verb (d) noun

Direction (Question Nos 6-10) : Choose the correct prepositions to fill in the blank.

6. The noise comes from _____ the river.
(a) over (b) inside
(c) across (d) under
7. The village was destroyed _____ fire.
(a) by (b) in
(c) at (d) to
8. They live _____ the same roof.
(a) into (b) under
(c) among (d) for
9. He was brought _____ the magistrate
(a) into (b) before
(c) along (d) at
10. I have not seen him _____ Friday last.
(a) on (b) over
(c) since (d) by

Direction (Question Nos 11-15) : Choose the correct verb form from the options provided.

11. French, as well as Korean, _____ taught there.
(a) are (b) was
(c) were (d) had
12. By the time we arrived at the station, the bus _____
(a) left (b) leaves
(c) had left (d) will leave
13. I wish he _____ me about the event; I would have changed all my plans accordingly.
(a) tells (b) told
(c) has told (d) had told
14. By the time the project finishes, we _____ all our funds.
(a) will have used (b) used
(c) use (d) had used
15. Scarcely _____ the bell rung when the students rushed out of the classroom.
(a) was (b) had
(c) has (d) did

Direction (Question Nos 16-20) : Choose the appropriate pronouns from the given options.

16. _____ of them is to blame.
(a) Some (b) Each
(c) All (d) Few
17. One must take care of _____ health.
(a) his (b) their
(c) one's (d) it
18. _____ did you meet?
(a) Who (b) Whom
(c) Whose (d) Which
19. Between you and _____, I think this is a great idea.
(a) I (b) Me
(c) Mine (d) Myself
20. Neither of the two brothers has called to say that _____ will be home.
(a) he (b) they
(c) him (d) their

Direction (Question Nos. 21-25) : In the given sentence identify the segment which contains the grammatical error.

21. Despite of his hard work, he did not succeed in passing the exam.
(a) Despite of (b) His hard work
(c) He did not succeed (d) No error
22. The professor, along with his students, are conducting a scientific experiment on refraction of light.
(a) The professor (b) along with his students
(c) are conducting a scientific experiment (d) on refraction of light

23. Each of the employees in the company have received their bonus.
(a) Each of the employees (b) In the company
(c) have received (d) their bonus
24. No sooner the meeting began than the director received an urgent call.
(a) No sooner (b) the meeting began
(c) than the director (d) received an urgent call
25. The reason why he left the job was because he had personal reasons.
(a) The reason why (b) he left the job
(c) was because (d) he had personal reasons.

Direction (Question Nos. 26-30) : Choose the correct answer from the given choices.

26. The scientist was able to _____ the results of the experiment with strong evidence.
(a) illicit (b) elicit
(c) solicit (d) explicit
27. The politician's speech was filled with _____ statements, making it difficult to determine his true stance on the issue.
(a) candid (b) explicit
(c) equivocal (d) incontrovertible
28. The teacher's explanation was so _____ that even the most confused students understood the concept.
(a) vague (b) clear
(c) ambiguous (d) perplexing
29. The detective was able to _____ the truth after carefully examining the proof.
(a) ascertain (b) fabricate
(c) obscure (d) misconstrue
30. The chairman's decision was _____ leaving no room for further talk.
(a) tentative (b) final
(c) ambiguous (d) indefinite

Direction (Question Nos 31-35) : Choose the one which can be substituted for the given words/sentence.

31. A person who walks in sleep.
(a) Insomniac (b) Somnambulist
(c) Philatelist (d) Pessimist
32. A speech given without preparation.
(a) Oration (b) Rhetoric
(c) Extempore (d) Manuscript
33. One who does not believe in the existence of God.
(a) Theist (b) Atheist
(c) Agnostic (d) Pious
34. A place where birds are kept.
(a) Aviary (b) Apiary
(c) Aquarium (d) Barn

35. A word or phrase that reads the same backward and forward.

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| (a) Euphemism | (b) Oxymoron |
| (c) Palindrome | (d) Anagram |

Direction (Question Nos 36-40) : Select the incorrectly spelt word.

36.

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| (a) Nauseous | (b) Perseverance |
| (c) Vacillate | (d) Embelish |

37.

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| (a) Ineffable | (b) Connoisseur |
| (c) Belligerant | (d) Idiosyncrasy |

38.

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|----------------|-------------------|
| (a) Dilemma | (b) Entrepreneur |
| (c) Exhuberant | (d) Surreptitious |

39.

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|------------------|--------------------|
| (a) Onomatopoeia | (b) Precipituous |
| (c) Parsimonious | (d) Quintessential |

40.

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|----------------|-------------------|
| (a) Hambouyant | (b) Convalescence |
| (c) Harangue | (d) Eccentricity |

Direction (Question Nos. 41-45): Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order :

41. A : She went to the park.

B: She sat on a bench.

C: It was a bright, sunny day.

D: She was enjoying fresh air.

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| (a) ABCD | (b) CABD |
| (c) DBAC | (d) CDBA |

42. A : He picked up his bag and rushed out of the house

B: He quickly got ready and ate his breakfast.

C: Tom woke up late in the morning.

D: He had an important meeting at work

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| (a) CBDA | (b) DBCA |
| (c) CBAD | (d) ABDC |

43. A: She loved painting landscapes.

B: Eve had a deep passion for art.

C: Every evening, she spent hours with her paintbrushes

D: Here artworks were admired by everyone.

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| (a) ABCD | (b) BCAD |
| (c) BACD | (d) CBDA |

44. A: They were excited to spend the day there.
B: The family decided to visit the beach.
C: They packed their bags with snacks and sunscreen
D: The children ran towards the waves as soon as they arrived.
(a) BCAD (b) CBDA
(c) ABCD (d) BACD
45. A: He looked at the sky, hoping for rain.
B: The heat was unbearable in the afternoon.
C: But the sun continued to shine brightly.
D: He longed for some cool breeze.
(a) ABCD (b) BDAC
(c) BACD (d) DBAC

Direction (Question Nos. 46 - 50): Choose the correct sentence structure from the given options.

46.
(a) The boy who plays football every evening.
(b) The boy plays football every evening.
(c) The boy playing football every evening
(d) The boy play football every evening.
47.
(a) Although he was tired, but he continued working.
(b) Although he was tired, yet he continued working.
(c) Although he was tired, he continued working.
(d) Although he was tired but he continued working.
48.
(a) No sooner had he left than it started raining.
(b) No sooner he had left than it started raining.
(c) No sooner had he left when it started raining.
(d) No sooner he left than it started raining.
49.
(a) She insisted me to join the team. (b) She insisted on me joining the team.
(c) She insisted that I join the team. (d) She insisted that I should joining the team.
50.
(a) She prefers coffee than tea. (b) She prefers coffee more than tea.
(c) She prefers coffee over tea. (d) She prefers coffee to tea.

Direction (Question Nos 51 - 55) : Complete the sentence with the most suitable phrase :

51. No sooner had I reached the station _____
(a) when the train had already left (b) than the train left
(c) then the train is leaving (d) but the train is yet to leave
52. Had it not been for his timely intervention, _____
(a) the situation would have worsened
(b) the situation is improving
(c) the problem was solved easily
(d) he will be appreciated

53. Not until the investigation was completed _____
(a) the truth had already come out (b) did the truth come to light
(c) the authorities knew the truth (d) has the truth been revealed.
54. Only after years of training _____
(a) he can easily perform the task (b) he is learning the technique
(c) was he able to master the skill (d) he understands the importance of practice.
55. Little did they realize _____
(a) and they had already anticipated the results.
(b) so they were prepared for the outcome
(c) that their decision would have long-term consequences
(d) since they understood the risk from the start.

Direction (Question Nos 56 - 60): Change the following into a conditional sentence.

56. She missed the bus because she left late.
(a) If she left on time, she would not miss the bus.
(b) If she had left on time, she would not have missed the bus.
(c) If she leaves on time, she will not miss the bus.
(d) If she had left on time, she will not miss the bus.
57. I don't have enough money, so I can't buy a car.
(a) If I had enough money, I would buy a car.
(b) If I have enough money I will buy a car.
(c) If I had had enough money, I would buy a car.
(d) If I had enough money, I will buy a car
58. You must study regularly to do well in exams.
(a) If you studied regularly, you will do well in exams.
(b) If you have studied regularly, you would have scored well.
(c) If you had studied regularly, you will score well.
(d) If you study regularly, you will score well in exams.
59. She is not careful, so she often makes mistakes.
(a) If she is careful, she will not make mistakes.
(b) If she was careful, she would not make mistakes.
(c) If she were careful, she would not make mistakes.
(d) If she had been careful, she would not make mistakes.
60. They speak too fast, so we cannot understand them.
(a) If they spoke slowly, we could understand them.
(b) If they speak slowly, we could understand them.
(c) If they had spoken slowly, we could understand them.
(d) If they would speak slowly, we could understand them.

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